

BioDYM

User Manual

Material Flow Analysis with Dynamic Stock
and Decay Modeling

Version 1.0

February 2026

Built on the ODYM Framework

Johannes Scholz
TU Berlin — Chair of Circular Economy and Recycling Technology

Contents

1	Introduction	5
1.1	What is BioDYM?	5
1.2	The Element Concept	5
1.2.1	Element Hierarchy	6
1.3	System Architecture	6
1.4	Process Types	6
2	Installation & Setup	7
2.1	Requirements	7
2.2	Installation	7
2.3	Starting Jupyter	7
2.4	Project Structure	8
3	The BioDYM Workflow	9
3.1	Overview	9
3.2	Step 1: Setup & Data Loading	9
3.3	Step 2: Calculation & Validation	10
3.4	Step 3: Visualization	10
3.5	Step 4: Export & Advanced Analysis	10
4	Excel Configuration	12
4.1	Sheet Overview	12
4.2	Configuration Sheet	12
4.3	Flow Definitions (Sheet 1_1)	13
4.3.1	Required Columns	13
4.3.2	Naming Convention	13
4.4	Flow Data (Sheet 1_2)	13
4.5	Process Definitions (Sheet 2_1)	13
4.5.1	Process Logic Values	13
4.5.2	Stock Configuration Values	14
4.6	Transfer Coefficients	14
4.6.1	Static TCs (Sheet 2_2)	14
4.6.2	Dynamic TCs (Sheet 2_3)	14
4.6.3	TC Naming Convention	14
4.7	Initial Stock (Sheet 2_4)	15
5	Running the Calculation	16
5.1	The Iterative Solver	16
5.2	Process Logic Details	16
5.2.1	Splitter	16
5.2.2	Transformer	16

5.2.3	Pass-through	17
5.3	Final Balances	17
5.4	Mass Balance Verification	17
5.5	Element Hierarchy Recalculation	17
6	Visualization	18
6.1	Sankey Diagram	18
6.2	Process Dynamics (3-Panel View)	18
6.3	Flow Dynamics	18
6.4	Stock Analysis	18
6.5	DSM Stock Details	19
6.6	Composition Analysis	19
6.7	Exporting Plots	19
6.8	Color Scheme	19
7	Dynamic Stock Model (DSM)	20
7.1	Concept	20
7.2	Configuration (Sheet 3_1)	20
7.3	Categories	20
7.4	Lifetime Distributions	21
7.4.1	Fixed	21
7.4.2	Normal	21
7.4.3	FoldedNormal	21
7.4.4	LogNormal	21
7.4.5	Weibull	21
7.5	DSM Outflow Distribution	21
7.6	Initial Stock	22
8	First-Order Multi-Pool (FOMP)	23
8.1	Concept	23
8.2	Configuration (Sheet 3_2)	23
8.3	Element Handling	24
8.4	Use Cases	24
9	Monte Carlo Simulation	25
9.1	Concept	25
9.2	Configuration (Sheet 4_1)	25
9.2.1	Available Distributions	25
9.3	Running MC Simulation	26
9.4	TC Normalization	26
9.5	Results	26
10	Scenario Analysis	27
10.1	Concept	27
10.2	Configuration (Sheet 5_1)	27
10.2.1	Modification Types	27
10.2.2	Time Range	27
10.3	Supported Parameters	27
10.4	Running Scenarios	28
10.5	Comparison Plots	28
11	Results Export	29
11.1	KPI Dashboard	29

11.2	Results Excel Export	29
11.3	Composition Export	29
11.4	Plot Export	29
11.5	Monte Carlo Results	30
11.6	Scenario Results	30
A	Distribution Functions Reference	31
A.1	DSM Lifetime Distributions	31
A.1.1	Fixed	31
A.1.2	Normal	31
A.1.3	FoldedNormal	31
A.1.4	LogNormal	32
A.1.5	Weibull	32
A.2	Monte Carlo Sampling Distributions	32
A.2.1	Normal (Bounded)	32
A.2.2	Uniform	32
A.2.3	Triangular	33
A.2.4	LogNormal (Bounded)	33
B	Excel Sheet Quick Reference	34
B.1	Sheet Summary	34
B.2	Naming Conventions	35
B.3	Process Logic Behavior	35
C	Troubleshooting	36
C.1	Installation Issues	36
C.2	Data Loading Errors	36
C.3	Calculation Errors	36
C.4	Visualization Issues	37
C.5	Monte Carlo Issues	37
C.6	Getting Help	37

Chapter 1

Introduction

1.1 What is BioDYM?

BioDYM is a Material Flow Analysis (MFA) framework built on top of the Open Dynamic Material Systems Model (ODYM). It provides a complete workflow for modeling material flows, stocks, and transformations in bio-based and industrial systems.

BioDYM extends ODYM with:

- **Dynamic Stock Modeling (DSM)** — Cohort-based stock tracking with configurable lifetime distributions (Normal, Weibull, LogNormal, etc.)
- **First-Order Multi-Pool decay (FOMP)** — Two-pool organic matter decomposition (labile and recalcitrant fractions)
- **Monte Carlo Simulation** — Uncertainty quantification with multiple distribution types and sensitivity analysis
- **Scenario Analysis** — Define and compare parameter modifications across multiple scenarios
- **Excel-based Configuration** — All model inputs defined in a single Excel workbook
- **Interactive Visualization** — Sankey diagrams, dynamics plots, stock analysis, and publication-quality export

1.2 The Element Concept

BioDYM tracks multiple *elements* simultaneously across all flows and stocks. Elements represent mass-conserved quantities that are tracked in parallel:

Element	Abbreviation	Description
Material	material	Total mass (always the first element)
Water Content	WC	Mass of water in the flow
Dry Matter	DM	Mass of dry matter (material = WC + DM)
Carbon Content	CC	Mass of carbon in the dry matter

Table 1.1: Default element configuration for biomass systems.

Elements can be configured for any application. For example, a metals system might use `[material, Fe, Cu, Al]`, while a packaging system might use `[material, PET, PE, PP]`.

1.2.1 Element Hierarchy

Elements can have parent–child relationships. In the default biomass configuration:

- DM is defined as a *percentage of material*
- CC is defined as a *percentage of DM* (not of material)

This hierarchy is configured in the Excel workbook and automatically maintained by the calculation engine.

1.3 System Architecture

A BioDYM model consists of:

Processes Nodes in the system (e.g., Forestry, Processing, Use Phase)

Flows Directed connections between processes, carrying mass of each element over time

Stocks Material accumulated within a process

Transfer Coefficients (TCs) Parameters controlling how material is distributed from a process to its outflows

Parameters All model inputs: flow data, compositions, TC values, DSM/FOMP configurations

Process 0 is always the *system boundary* (environment). Flows from Process 0 into the system are inputs; flows to Process 0 are outputs.

1.4 Process Types

Each process has a *logic* that determines how it handles material:

Process Logic	Behavior
Input	System entry point (boundary process)
Splitter	Distributes material to outflows using TCs; preserves element composition
Transformer	Distributes material using element-specific TCs; changes composition
Pass-through	Passes all inflow directly to a single outflow
DSM	Dynamic stock with cohort-based lifetime tracking
FOMP	First-order multi-pool organic matter decay

Table 1.2: Available process logic types in BioDYM.

Chapter 2

Installation & Setup

2.1 Requirements

- Python 3.12 or later
- uv package manager (<https://docs.astral.sh/uv/>)
- Git (for cloning the repository)
- Microsoft Excel or LibreOffice Calc (for editing input files)

2.2 Installation

1. Clone the repository:

```
git clone https://github.com/JScholz-tech/Biodym_JS.git
cd Biodym_JS
```

2. Install dependencies with uv:

```
uv sync
```

This creates a virtual environment in `.venv/` and installs all dependencies from `pyproject.toml`.

3. Verify the installation:

```
uv run python -m pytest 04_tests/ -v
```

All tests should pass. If any fail, check the Troubleshooting appendix (Appendix C).

2.3 Starting Jupyter

BioDYM is operated through a Jupyter notebook:

```
uv run jupyter lab
```

Then open `00_BioDYM_Workflow.ipynb` in the browser. This is the main user interface.

Tip

The notebook is paired with a Python script `00_BioDYM_Workflow.py` via Jupyter. If you edit the `.py` file, synchronize with:

```
jupytertext --to notebook 00_BioDYM_Workflow.py
```

2.4 Project Structure

<code>bioDYM-CERT-edit-main/</code>	
<code>00_BioDYM_Workflow.ipynb</code>	Main notebook (user interface)
<code>00_BioDYM_Workflow.py</code>	Paired Python source (Jupyter)
<code>01_data/</code>	
<code>01_input/</code>	Excel input files
<code>02_output/</code>	Calculation results, exports
<code>02_src/</code>	
<code>engine/</code>	Solver, DSM, FOMP, MC engines
<code>plotting/</code>	All visualization modules
<code>system_setup.py</code>	Model initialization
<code>data_loader.py</code>	Excel data loading
<code>utils.py</code>	Export and helper functions
<code>03_studies/</code>	Case study configurations
<code>04_tests/</code>	Automated test suite
<code>05_docs/</code>	Documentation
<code>06_framework/</code>	ODYM base framework

Chapter 3

The BioDYM Workflow

The BioDYM workflow is organized into four sequential steps, each corresponding to a section in the Jupyter notebook.

3.1 Overview

1. **Setup & Data Loading** — Load the Excel workbook, validate input data, initialize the MFA system
2. **Calculation & Validation** — Run the iterative solver, check mass balance, verify results
3. **Visualization** — Explore results with interactive plots (Sankey, dynamics, stocks, composition)
4. **Export & Advanced Analysis** — Export results, run Monte Carlo simulation, run scenarios

3.2 Step 1: Setup & Data Loading

The notebook begins by loading your Excel configuration file:

```
# Set path to your Excel input file
input_file = "01_data/01_input/your_system.xlsm"

# Load and validate
model_scope = define_model_scope(input_file)
mfa_system = initialize_mfa_system(model_scope)
mfa_system = define_flows_and_parameters(mfa_system, input_file)
```

During loading, BioDYM:

- Reads all Excel sheets and validates their structure
- Creates Process, Flow, Stock, and Parameter objects
- Interpolates time series data to fill gaps between defined years
- Normalizes transfer coefficients so outflows sum to 100% per process
- Calculates element compositions from the defined fractions

Note

If data points are only defined for certain years (e.g., 2020 and 2030), BioDYM automatically interpolates linearly for all intermediate years.

3.3 Step 2: Calculation & Validation

The MFA calculation uses an iterative solver:

```
mfa_system_results = run_mfa_calculation(mfa_system, ...)
```

The solver repeatedly passes through all processes until no flow values change between iterations (convergence). In each pass:

1. For each flow, the solver checks if the source process has calculated inflows
2. If yes, it applies the appropriate process logic (Splitter, Transformer, DSM, FOMP)
3. Transfer coefficients determine how inflow is distributed to outflows
4. Final balances are calculated: $\Delta S = \text{inflow} - \text{outflow}$ for each process

After calculation, the mass balance is displayed:

```
Mass Balance Check (material):
  Process 1 (Forestry):      Error = 0.00e+00
  Process 2 (Processing):    Error = 0.00e+00
  Process 3 (Use Phase):     Error = 2.13e-10
```

Errors below 10^{-6} are normal (floating-point precision). Larger errors indicate a configuration problem.

3.4 Step 3: Visualization

BioDYM provides interactive Plotly-based visualizations (see Chapter 6 for details):

- **Sankey diagram** — Overview of all flows, filterable by element and year
- **Process dynamics** — Inflow, outflow, and stock change per process over time
- **Flow dynamics** — Time series of individual flows
- **Stock analysis** — Bar charts and time series of accumulated stocks
- **Composition analysis** — Element composition of flows and stocks
- **DSM stock details** — Per-category stock evolution for DSM processes

3.5 Step 4: Export & Advanced Analysis

Results can be exported and further analyzed:

- **Excel export** — All flows, stocks, and parameters to `.xlsx`
- **KPI dashboard** — Key performance indicators (total input, output, stock, recycling rates)
- **Monte Carlo** — Uncertainty analysis (Chapter 9)

- **Scenarios** — Parameter comparison studies (Chapter [10](#))

Chapter 4

Excel Configuration

All model inputs are defined in a single Excel workbook (.xlsm or .xlsx). This chapter describes each sheet and its required columns.

4.1 Sheet Overview

Sheet Name	Purpose	Required
Configuration	Time range, elements, flags	Yes
1_1_Definition_Flows	Flow definitions and connections	Yes
1_2_Data_Flows	Flow time series data	Yes
2_1_Definition_Processes	Process definitions and logic	Yes
2_2_static_TCs	Static transfer coefficients	Optional
2_3_dynamic_TCs	Time-varying transfer coefficients	Optional
2_4_Initial_Stock	Initial stock values	Optional
3_1_Definition_DSM	DSM parameters	If DSM used
3_2_Definition_FOMP	FOMP parameters	If FOMP used
4_1_Uncertainty_Parameters	Monte Carlo distributions	If MC used
5_1_Scenario_Definitions	Scenario configurations	If scenarios used

Table 4.1: Excel workbook sheets.

4.2 Configuration Sheet

Defines global model settings.

Parameter	Example	Description
Start_Year	2020	First year of the model
End_Year	2050	Last year of the model
Elements	material,WC,DM,CC	Comma-separated element list
Element_ID_X	CC	Element name for hierarchy
Parent_Element_ID_X	DM	Parent element name

Table 4.2: Configuration sheet parameters.

4.3 Flow Definitions (Sheet 1_1)

Defines all flows in the system: their source, destination, and element composition.

4.3.1 Required Columns

Column	Example	Description
Flow_ID	F_01_02	Unique flow identifier
Source_Process	1	ID of the starting process
Target_Process	2	ID of the ending process
E1_name	WC[%]	First element name (composition fraction)
E1_value	60	Fraction of material that is this element (%)
E2_name	CC_DM[%]	Second element (CC as % of DM)
E2_value	45	Fraction value

Table 4.3: Flow definition columns.

4.3.2 Naming Convention

Flow IDs follow the pattern F_<source>_<target>_<name>:

- F_01_02 — Flow from Process 1 to Process 2
- F_05_00_CO2 — CO₂ flow from Process 5 to the environment

4.4 Flow Data (Sheet 1_2)

Contains time series values for input flows (flows from the system boundary).

Flow_ID	Year	E1_value	Unit
F_00_01	2020	1000	Mg
F_00_01	2030	1500	Mg
F_00_01	2050	2000	Mg

Table 4.4: Flow data example. Years between data points are interpolated linearly.

Tip

You only need to provide data for key years. BioDYM interpolates linearly between them. For example, defining values at 2020, 2030, and 2050 will automatically fill all intermediate years.

4.5 Process Definitions (Sheet 2_1)

Defines each process node in the system.

4.5.1 Process Logic Values

- **Input** — System boundary (Process 0); source of input flows

Column	Example	Description
ID	3	Unique process number
Name	Use_Phase	Human-readable name
Process_Logic	Splitter	How the process handles material
Stock_Configuration	Stock	Whether the process has a stock

Table 4.5: Process definition columns.

- **Splitter** — Distributes inflow to outflows by TCs; preserves composition
- **Transformer** — Like Splitter, but allows element-specific TCs (changes composition)
- **Pass-through** — Passes all material directly to a single outflow
- **DSM** — Dynamic stock model with lifetime distributions
- **FOMP** — First-order multi-pool organic matter decay

4.5.2 Stock Configuration Values

- **NoStock** — Process has no stock
- **Stock** — Process accumulates stock (zero initial stock)
- **Stock_with_InitialStock_Decay** — Stock with initial value, simple exponential decay
- **Stock_with_InitialStock_Cohort** — Stock with initial value, ODYM age-cohort method

4.6 Transfer Coefficients

TCs control how material leaving a process is distributed among its outflows.

4.6.1 Static TCs (Sheet 2_2)

Constant values that don't change over time:

TC_ID	Value	Unit
TC_05_06	0.7	1
TC_05_07	0.3	1

Table 4.6: Static TC example. Outflows from Process 5: 70% to Process 6, 30% to Process 7.

4.6.2 Dynamic TCs (Sheet 2_3)

Time-varying values, defined at key years and interpolated:

4.6.3 TC Naming Convention

- **Standard:** TC_<source>_<target> — e.g., TC_05_06
- **Element-specific:** TC_E<idx>_<source>_<target> — e.g., TC_E2_05_06 for the WC-specific TC

TC_ID	Year	Value
TC_05_06	2020	0.6
TC_05_06	2040	0.8
TC_05_07	2020	0.4
TC_05_07	2040	0.2

Table 4.7: Dynamic TC example. Values interpolated between 2020 and 2040.

Element-specific TCs are only used with *Transformer* processes. Splitters use the same TC for all elements.

Warning

TCs for all outflows of a process must sum to 1.0 (100%) at every time step. BioDYM normalizes automatically if they don't, but will print a warning if the deviation exceeds 5%.

4.7 Initial Stock (Sheet 2_4)

Defines starting stock values for processes with stock configuration:

Process_ID	Parameter_Name	Parameter_Value	Unit
1	Initial_Stock_material	5000	Mg
1	Initial_Stock_WC[%]	15	%
1	Initial_Stock_DM[%]	85	%
1	Initial_Stock_CC[%]	45	%
1	Annual_Consumption_Rate	0.05	1/year

Table 4.8: Initial stock configuration example.

Chapter 5

Running the Calculation

5.1 The Iterative Solver

BioDYM uses an iterative convergence solver. In each pass, it processes all flows in the system:

1. Check if a flow's source process has calculated inflows available
2. If yes, apply the process logic (Splitter, Transformer, DSM, FOMP)
3. Compute outflow values using transfer coefficients
4. Repeat until no flow values change between passes

This approach handles circular flows (recycling loops) naturally — each pass propagates values further through the system until convergence.

```
mfa_system_results = run_mfa_calculation(  
    mfa_system,  
    dsm_params_config=dsm_params,          # Optional: DSM parameters  
    fomp_params_config=fomp_params,        # Optional: FOMP parameters  
    process_logic_map=process_logic_map,  
    flow_tc_map=flow_tc_map,  
    initial_stock_configs=initial_stock_configs,  
)
```

5.2 Process Logic Details

5.2.1 Splitter

Distributes the total inflow to outflows using transfer coefficients. All elements maintain their input composition:

$$F_{\text{out},e} = F_{\text{in},e} \times \text{TC}_{\text{material}} \quad (5.1)$$

where e is the element index and TC is the material-level transfer coefficient.

5.2.2 Transformer

Like Splitter, but allows element-specific TCs. The composition of the outflow can differ from the inflow:

$$F_{\text{out},e} = F_{\text{in},e} \times \text{TC}_e \quad (5.2)$$

where TC_e can be different for each element.

5.2.3 Pass-through

Passes all inflow directly to a single outflow without modification:

$$F_{\text{out}} = F_{\text{in}} \quad (5.3)$$

5.3 Final Balances

After convergence, the solver calculates the stock change for every process:

$$\Delta S_p = \sum F_{\text{in},p} - \sum F_{\text{out},p} \quad (5.4)$$

For DSM processes, the stock S is calculated by the DSM engine (cohort tracking), and the solver preserves it. For all other processes, ΔS is the algebraic residual.

5.4 Mass Balance Verification

After calculation, a mass balance check is displayed for each process and element:

$$\text{Balance}_p = \sum F_{\text{in},p} - \sum F_{\text{out},p} - \Delta S_p \quad (5.5)$$

This should be zero (or very close to zero, within floating-point tolerance $\sim 10^{-10}$) for every process.

Warning

If you see mass balance errors larger than 10^{-3} Mg, check your transfer coefficients and flow definitions. Common causes:

- TCs not summing to 1.0 for a process
- Missing outflows for a process with inflows
- Incorrect element composition percentages

5.5 Element Hierarchy Recalculation

After TC application, hierarchical elements are recalculated to maintain consistency. For example, if CC is defined as a percentage of DM, the solver ensures:

$$\text{CC}_{\text{out}} = \text{DM}_{\text{out}} \times \frac{\text{CC}_{\text{in}}}{\text{DM}_{\text{in}}} \quad (5.6)$$

This prevents “transmutation” of elements — each flow maintains physically consistent composition.

Chapter 6

Visualization

BioDYM provides interactive Plotly-based visualizations in the Jupyter notebook. All plots follow a consistent publication style and can be exported as PNG (150 or 300 DPI), PDF, or SVG.

6.1 Sankey Diagram

The Sankey diagram provides a system-level overview of all material flows. Interactive controls:

- **Element selector** — Switch between material, WC, DM, CC
- **Year slider** — View flows for any year in the model range
- **Threshold** — Hide flows below a minimum value

Flow widths are proportional to mass. Node colors follow the process type color scheme.

6.2 Process Dynamics (3-Panel View)

For each process, a three-panel plot shows:

1. **Top panel:** Inflows over time
2. **Middle panel:** Outflows over time
3. **Bottom panel:** Stock change (ΔS) over time

Select the process and element via dropdown menus.

6.3 Flow Dynamics

Time series plots of individual flows. Useful for verifying that input data was loaded correctly and that calculated flows behave as expected.

6.4 Stock Analysis

- **Stock bar chart** — Stacked bar showing stock levels across all processes at a selected year
- **System stock composition** — Element breakdown of total system stock over time

6.5 DSM Stock Details

For processes with DSM logic, a specialized plot shows:

- Stock evolution stacked by category (e.g., construction wood types)
- Selectable by process and element
- Includes decaying initial stock contribution

See Chapter 7 for details on DSM configuration.

6.6 Composition Analysis

Interactive composition explorer showing the element fractions (WC, DM, CC) for each flow at each time step. Useful for verifying that compositions are physically consistent.

6.7 Exporting Plots

Each interactive plot has an export button or can be exported programmatically:

```
fig.write_image("my_plot.png", width=1200, height=800, scale=2)
```

Tip

For publication-quality figures, use `scale=3` (300 DPI at 1200px width). The publication style module automatically applies consistent fonts, colors, and layout.

6.8 Color Scheme

BioDYM uses a consistent color palette:

Purpose	Color	Hex Code
Material element	Blue	#2E86AB
WC element	Green	#28A745
DM element	Gray	#6C757D
CC element	Yellow	#FFC107
Splitter process	Blue	#2E86AB
Transformer process	Pink	#A23B72

Table 6.1: Standard color palette.

Chapter 7

Dynamic Stock Model (DSM)

7.1 Concept

The Dynamic Stock Model tracks material that enters a process and remains in stock for a defined lifetime before leaving as outflow. It uses *cohort-based tracking*: each year's inflow is a separate cohort that decays according to a lifetime distribution.

$$S(t) = \sum_{\tau=0}^t I(\tau) \cdot [1 - F_{\text{CDF}}(t - \tau)] \quad (7.1)$$

where $S(t)$ is the stock at time t , $I(\tau)$ is the inflow in year τ , and F_{CDF} is the cumulative distribution function of the lifetime.

7.2 Configuration (Sheet 3_1)

DSM parameters are defined in the `3_1_Definition_DSM` sheet using a key-value format:

Parameter	Example	Description
Process_ID	7	Process to apply DSM to
DSM_Inflow_Split_Cat_1	0.6	60% of inflow to Category 1
DSM_Inflow_Split_Cat_2	0.4	40% of inflow to Category 2
DSM_Lifetime_Type_Cat_1	Normal	Distribution type for Cat. 1
DSM_Lifetime_Mean_Cat_1	30	Mean lifetime (years)
DSM_Lifetime_StdDev_Cat_1	5	Standard deviation (years)
DSM_Lifetime_Type_Cat_2	Weibull	Distribution type for Cat. 2
DSM_Lifetime_Mean_Cat_2	50	Mean lifetime (years)
DSM_Lifetime_Shape_Cat_2	2.5	Weibull shape parameter
DSM_Category_Name_Cat_1	Short-lived	Display name
DSM_Category_Name_Cat_2	Long-lived	Display name

Table 7.1: DSM parameter configuration.

7.3 Categories

DSM supports multiple categories per process. Each category receives a fraction of the total inflow (`Inflow_Split`) and has its own lifetime distribution. This models heterogeneous

products — for example, construction wood split into short-lived (interior) and long-lived (structural) applications.

Note

The inflow splits must sum to 1.0 across all categories.

7.4 Lifetime Distributions

Five distribution types are available:

7.4.1 Fixed

All items leave stock at exactly the mean lifetime. Parameters: **Mean**.

7.4.2 Normal

Symmetric bell curve around the mean. Parameters: **Mean**, **StdDev**.

Warning

If **StdDev** exceeds 80% of **Mean**, some lifetimes become negative. Use *FoldedNormal* instead.

7.4.3 FoldedNormal

Like Normal, but negative values are folded to positive. Eliminates the negative lifetime problem. Parameters: **Mean**, **StdDev**.

7.4.4 LogNormal

Right-skewed distribution where some items last much longer than average. Always positive. Parameters: **Mean**, **StdDev** (of the lognormal curve, not of $\ln$).

7.4.5 Weibull

Flexible distribution controlled by the **Shape** parameter:

- Shape < 1: Decreasing failure rate (infant mortality)
- Shape = 1: Constant failure rate (exponential decay)
- Shape > 1: Increasing failure rate (wear-out failures)
- Shape ≈ 3.6 : Approximates a normal distribution

Parameters: **Mean**, **Shape**.

See Appendix A for the complete mathematical reference.

7.5 DSM Outflow Distribution

Outflows from DSM processes are distributed to downstream flows using the standard TC system. This means DSM outflow splits can be:

- Static (constant fractions)

- Dynamic (time-varying, from 2_3_dynamic_TCs)
- Subject to Monte Carlo sampling

7.6 Initial Stock

DSM processes can start with an existing stock that decays over time. Two methods are available:

- **Exponential decay:** Simple decay based on mean lifetime
- **ODYM age-cohort:** Rigorous method that reconstructs the age distribution of the initial stock

Configure via `Stock_Configuration` in the process definition sheet.

Chapter 8

First-Order Multi-Pool (FOMP)

8.1 Concept

The First-Order Mineralization Process model simulates organic matter decomposition using two pools with different decay rates:

- **Labile pool** — Easily degradable fraction, fast decay ($k_{\text{labile}} \approx 0.1\text{--}1.0/\text{year}$)
- **Recalcitrant pool** — Resistant fraction, slow decay ($k_{\text{recalcitrant}} \approx 0.01\text{--}0.05/\text{year}$)

Each pool follows first-order kinetics:

$$\frac{dS_i}{dt} = I_i(t) - k_i \cdot S_i(t) \quad (8.1)$$

where S_i is the stock in pool i , I_i is the inflow to pool i , and k_i is the decay rate constant.

The analytical solution for each time step is:

$$\text{Decay}_i(t) = S_i(t) \cdot (1 - e^{-k_i}) \quad (8.2)$$

8.2 Configuration (Sheet 3_2)

FOMP parameters are defined in the 3_2_Definition_FOMP sheet:

Parameter	Example	Description
Process_ID	4	Process to apply FOMP to
f_labile	0.7	Fraction of inflow to labile pool
k_labile	0.5	Labile decay rate (1/year)
k_recalcitrant	0.025	Recalcitrant decay rate (1/year)
outflow_id	F_04_00_CO2	Carbon outflow (mineralization)
outflow_id_2	F_04_00_env	Environmental outflow (non-carbon)

Table 8.1: FOMP parameter configuration.

Note

The recalcitrant fraction is automatically calculated as $f_{\text{recalcitrant}} = 1 - f_{\text{labile}}$.

8.3 Element Handling

FOMP processes handle elements differently based on their nature:

Carbon outflow Contains the mineralized carbon mass. Elements: material = DM = CC = carbon mass.

Environmental outflow Contains the non-carbon dry matter and bypassed water. Elements calculated as:

- WC = water content of inflow (bypasses decay)
- DM = non-carbon dry matter decay
- CC = 0 (all carbon goes to carbon outflow)

8.4 Use Cases

FOMP is appropriate for modeling:

- Composting processes (labile fraction decays in weeks, recalcitrant in years)
- Soil organic matter turnover
- Anaerobic digestion (with adjusted rate constants)
- Landfill degradation (very slow recalcitrant decay)

Warning

FOMP uses a time-averaged CC/DM ratio as a constant for element calculations. This approximation can cause a small mass balance error ($\sim 2\%$) for the CC element. This is a known modeling limitation, not a bug.

Chapter 9

Monte Carlo Simulation

9.1 Concept

Monte Carlo (MC) simulation quantifies how uncertainty in input parameters propagates through the model. In each iteration:

1. Sample random values for selected parameters from their defined distributions
2. Apply the sampled values to the MFA system
3. Run the solver
4. Record the results

After N iterations, the distribution of results shows the uncertainty range for all flows and stocks.

9.2 Configuration (Sheet 4_1)

Uncertainty parameters are defined in the `4_1_Uncertainty_Parameters` sheet:

Parameter_Name	Distribution	Mean	StdDev	Min	Max
TC_05_06	normal	0.65	0.05	0.4	0.9
F_00_01	uniform	–	–	900	1100
TC_03_04	triangular	–	–	0.3	0.5

Table 9.1: MC parameter configuration. The **Mode** column (not shown) is required for triangular distributions.

9.2.1 Available Distributions

normal Symmetric uncertainty. Parameters: **Mean**, **StdDev**. Optional: **Min**, **Max** for bounds.

uniform Equal probability within range. Parameters: **Min**, **Max**.

triangular Asymmetric with known most-likely value. Parameters: **Min**, **Max**, **Mode**.

lognormal Always positive, right-skewed. Parameters: **Mean**, **StdDev**. Optional: **Min**, **Max**.

9.3 Running MC Simulation

In the notebook:

```
mc_results = run_monte_carlo(  
    mfa_system_configured=mfa_system,  
    uncertainty_params=uncertainty_params,  
    n_iterations=100,  
    process_logic_map=process_logic_map,  
    flow_tc_map=flow_tc_map,  
    dsm_params_config=dsm_params,  
    fomp_params_config=fomp_params,  
)
```

Tip

Start with 100 iterations to verify the setup, then increase to 500–1000 for publication-quality results. Each iteration runs the full solver, so computation time scales linearly.

9.4 TC Normalization

When MC samples modify individual TCs, the outflow splits may no longer sum to 1.0. BioDYM uses *rejection sampling*: if sampled TCs deviate too far from 100%, the sample is rejected and redrawn. This preserves mass balance while respecting the defined uncertainty ranges.

9.5 Results

MC results include:

- **Summary statistics** — Mean, standard deviation, confidence intervals for all flows and stocks
- **Histograms** — Distribution of key output variables across iterations
- **Sensitivity analysis** — Tornado chart showing which parameters have the largest effect
- **Simulation paths** — Spaghetti plots showing all iterations overlaid
- **Mass balance check** — Per-process mass balance error across iterations (in scientific notation)

Chapter 10

Scenario Analysis

10.1 Concept

The scenario engine allows comparing different “what-if” situations against a baseline. Each scenario defines a set of parameter modifications that are applied before re-running the solver. All scenarios share the same system structure — only parameter values change.

10.2 Configuration (Sheet 5_1)

Scenarios are defined in the 5_1_Scenario_Definitions sheet:

Scenario	Parameter	Type	Value	Start	End
Scenario_A	TC_05_06	multiply	1.2	2030	2050
Scenario_A	F_00_01	add	200	2025	2040
Scenario_B	TC_05_06	set	0.9	2030	2050

Table 10.1: Scenario definition example.

10.2.1 Modification Types

set Replace the parameter with a fixed value

multiply Multiply the current value by a factor

add Add a value to the current parameter

10.2.2 Time Range

Each modification specifies a **Start_Year** and **End_Year**. The modification is only applied within this range. Outside the range, the baseline value is used.

10.3 Supported Parameters

The scenario engine auto-detects the parameter type from the naming pattern:

- **Transfer coefficients** — Names starting with TC_
- **Flow data** — Names starting with F_
- **DSM parameters** — Names containing DSM_

- **FOMP parameters** — Names containing FOMP_

10.4 Running Scenarios

```
all_scenario_results = run_all_scenarios(  
    mfa_system_configured=mfa_system,  
    scenario_definitions=scenario_definitions,  
    process_logic_map=process_logic_map,  
    flow_tc_map=flow_tc_map,  
    dsm_params_config=dsm_params,  
    fomp_params_config=fomp_params,  
)
```

Each scenario creates a deep copy of the baseline system, applies modifications, and re-runs the solver. Results are stored per scenario for comparison.

10.5 Comparison Plots

The scenario comparison visualization provides:

- **Flow dynamics** — Baseline vs. scenario flows over time
- **Stock dynamics** — Baseline vs. scenario stocks over time
- Multi-scenario selection (compare 2+ scenarios simultaneously)
- Element selector (view any tracked element)

Tip

Use scenarios to evaluate policy options (e.g., increased recycling rates), technology changes (e.g., new processing efficiency), or demand projections (e.g., reduced input flows).

Chapter 11

Results Export

11.1 KPI Dashboard

The KPI dashboard exports key performance indicators to `01_data/02_output/kpi_dashboard/system_kp`.

- Total system input (all elements)
- Total system output (all elements)
- Net stock change
- Cumulative input/output totals
- Per-process stock levels

11.2 Results Excel Export

The full results are exported to `01_data/02_output/results_scientific_baseline.xlsx`:

```
export_results_to_excel(  
    mfa_system_results,  
    output_path="01_data/02_output/results_scientific_baseline.xlsx"  
)
```

The export contains:

- **Flows sheet** — All flow values for all elements over time
- **Stocks sheet** — Stock levels (S) and stock changes (ΔS) per process
- **Parameters sheet** — All input parameters used in the calculation

11.3 Composition Export

Element composition data is exported to `01_data/02_output/composition_export/flow_composition.xlsx` containing the composition fractions (WC%, DM%, CC%) for every flow at every time step.

11.4 Plot Export

Individual plots can be exported via the export button on each interactive widget, or programmatically:

```
# PNG at 300 DPI
fig.write_image("plot.png", width=1200, height=800, scale=3)

# PDF (vector)
fig.write_image("plot.pdf", width=1200, height=800)

# SVG (vector, editable)
fig.write_image("plot.svg", width=1200, height=800)
```

11.5 Monte Carlo Results

MC results are displayed in the notebook via interactive plots. Summary statistics (mean, std, CI) for each variable are accessible programmatically from the `mc_results` dictionary.

11.6 Scenario Results

Scenario results are stored in the `all_scenario_results` dictionary, keyed by scenario name. Each entry contains a full solved MFA system that can be exported using the same `export_results_to_excel` function.

Appendix A

Distribution Functions Reference

This appendix provides the mathematical details for all distribution functions used in BioDYM.

A.1 DSM Lifetime Distributions

These distributions define how long material stays in stock before outflow.

A.1.1 Fixed

All items leave at exactly the mean lifetime.

$$f(t) = \delta(t - \mu) \quad F(t) = \begin{cases} 0 & t < \mu \\ 1 & t \geq \mu \end{cases} \quad (\text{A.1})$$

Parameters: **Mean** (μ).

A.1.2 Normal

$$f(t) = \frac{1}{\sigma\sqrt{2\pi}} \exp\left(-\frac{(t - \mu)^2}{2\sigma^2}\right) \quad (\text{A.2})$$

Parameters: **Mean** (μ), **StdDev** (σ).

Use when lifetime variation is symmetric. Warning: produces negative lifetimes when $\sigma > 0.8\mu$.

A.1.3 FoldedNormal

$$f(t) = \frac{1}{\sigma\sqrt{2\pi}} \left[\exp\left(-\frac{(t - \mu)^2}{2\sigma^2}\right) + \exp\left(-\frac{(t + \mu)^2}{2\sigma^2}\right) \right], \quad t \geq 0 \quad (\text{A.3})$$

Parameters: **Mean** (μ , before folding), **StdDev** (σ , before folding).

Eliminates negative lifetimes by folding the left tail onto the positive domain.

A.1.4 LogNormal

$$f(t) = \frac{1}{t \cdot \sigma_{\ln} \sqrt{2\pi}} \exp\left(-\frac{(\ln t - \mu_{\ln})^2}{2\sigma_{\ln}^2}\right), \quad t > 0 \quad (\text{A.4})$$

where $\mu_{\ln}$ and $\sigma_{\ln}$ are derived from the user-provided Mean and StdDev:

$$\sigma_{\ln}^2 = \ln\left(1 + \frac{\sigma^2}{\mu^2}\right), \quad \mu_{\ln} = \ln(\mu) - \frac{\sigma_{\ln}^2}{2} \quad (\text{A.5})$$

Parameters: **Mean** (μ), **StdDev** (σ) of the lognormal curve (not of $\ln t$).

Right-skewed; always positive. Use for electronics, machinery, vehicles.

A.1.5 Weibull

$$f(t) = \frac{k}{\lambda} \left(\frac{t}{\lambda}\right)^{k-1} \exp\left(-\left(\frac{t}{\lambda}\right)^k\right), \quad t \geq 0 \quad (\text{A.6})$$

where λ (scale) is derived from the user-provided Mean:

$$\lambda = \frac{\mu}{\Gamma(1 + 1/k)} \quad (\text{A.7})$$

Parameters: **Mean** (μ), **Shape** (k).

Shape (k)	Behavior
$k < 1$	Decreasing failure rate (infant mortality)
$k = 1$	Constant failure rate (exponential)
$k = 2$	Linear increase (Rayleigh distribution)
$k \approx 3.6$	Approximates normal distribution
$k > 5$	Narrow, nearly fixed lifetime

Table A.1: Weibull shape parameter guide.

A.2 Monte Carlo Sampling Distributions

These distributions define uncertainty ranges for parameter sampling.

A.2.1 Normal (Bounded)

Samples from $\mathcal{N}(\mu, \sigma^2)$, optionally clipped to $[\text{Min}, \text{Max}]$.

Parameters: **Mean**, **StdDev**. Optional: **Min**, **Max**.

A.2.2 Uniform

Samples uniformly from $[\text{Min}, \text{Max}]$:

$$f(x) = \frac{1}{\text{Max} - \text{Min}}, \quad x \in [\text{Min}, \text{Max}] \quad (\text{A.8})$$

Parameters: **Min**, **Max**.

A.2.3 Triangular

Samples from a triangle with peak at Mode:

$$f(x) = \begin{cases} \frac{2(x-a)}{(b-a)(c-a)} & a \leq x \leq c \\ \frac{2(b-x)}{(b-a)(b-c)} & c < x \leq b \end{cases} \quad (\text{A.9})$$

where $a = \text{Min}$, $b = \text{Max}$, $c = \text{Mode}$.

Parameters: `Min`, `Max`, `Mode`.

A.2.4 LogNormal (Bounded)

Samples from a lognormal distribution, optionally clipped. Same parameterization as the DSM LogNormal.

Parameters: `Mean`, `StdDev`. Optional: `Min`, `Max`.

Appendix B

Excel Sheet Quick Reference

B.1 Sheet Summary

Sheet	Key Columns	Notes
Configuration	Start_Year, End_Year, Elements	Global settings. Elements as comma-separated list.
1_1_Definition_Flows	Flow_ID, Source_Process, Target_Process, E1_name, E1_value	One row per flow. E-columns define composition fractions.
1_2_Data_Flows	Flow_ID, Year, E1_value, Unit	Input flow time series. Gaps interpolated linearly.
2_1_Definition_Processes	ID, Name, Process_Logic, Stock_Configuration	One row per process. Logic: Input, Splitter, Transformer, Pass-through, DSM, FOMP.
2_2_static_TCs	TC_ID, Value, Unit	Constant TCs. Must sum to 1.0 per source process.
2_3_dynamic_TCs	TC_ID, Year, Value	Time-varying TCs. Interpolated and normalized automatically.
2_4_Initial_Stock	Process_ID, Parameter_Name, Parameter_Value	Key-value pairs: Initial_Stock_material, Initial_Stock_WC[%], Annual_Consumption_Rate.
3_1_Definition_DSM	Process_ID, Parameter, Value	Key-value pairs: Inflow_Split, Lifetime_Type/Mean/StdDev/Shape per category.
3_2_Definition_FOMP	Process_ID, Parameter, Value	Key-value pairs: f_labile, k_labile, k_recalcitrant, outflow_id.

Sheet	Key Columns	Notes
4_1_Uncertainty_Parameters	Parameter_Name, Distribution_Type, Mean, StdDev, Min, Max, Mode	MC distributions. Types: normal, uniform, triangular, lognormal.
5_1_Scenario_Definitions	Scenario_Name, Parameter_Name, Modification_Type, Value, Start_Year, End_Year	Modification types: set, multiply, add.

B.2 Naming Conventions

Type	Pattern	Example
Flow	F_<src>_<dst> or F_<src>_<dst>_<name>	F_01_02, F_05_00_C02
TC (standard)	TC_<src>_<dst>	TC_05_06
TC (element)	TC_E<idx>_<src>_<dst>	TC_E2_05_06
Stock	S_<process>	S_7
Stock change	dS_<process>	dS_7

Table B.2: Naming patterns for system objects.

B.3 Process Logic Behavior

Logic	TC Type	Composition	Use Case
Input	None	Set by data	System boundary
Splitter	Material TC	Preserved	Distribution without transformation
Transformer	Element TCs	Changed	Chemical/physical conversion
Pass-through	None	Preserved	Direct connection
DSM	Material TC	Preserved	Stock with lifetime tracking
FOMP	Internal	Changed	Organic matter decay

Table B.3: Process logic comparison.

Appendix C

Troubleshooting

C.1 Installation Issues

“uv: command not found” Install uv: `curl -LsSf https://astral.sh/uv/install.sh | sh` (Linux/macOS) or see <https://docs.astral.sh/uv/> for Windows.

Tests fail after installation Run `uv sync` again to ensure all dependencies are installed. Check that Python 3.13+ is available: `python -version`.

Jupyter won’t start Ensure Jupyter is installed: `uv run pip install jupyterlab`. Then retry `uv run jupyter lab`.

C.2 Data Loading Errors

“Sheet not found” The Excel workbook is missing a required sheet. Check that all sheet names match exactly (including underscores and case).

“Column X not found” A required column is missing or misspelled. Compare your sheet headers with the reference in [Appendix B](#).

“No data for flow F_XX_YY” The flow is defined in sheet 1_1 but has no data in sheet 1_2. Add at least one data point.

Decimal separator issues BioDYM expects the period (.) as decimal separator. If your Excel uses commas, either change the system locale or save as CSV with periods.

C.3 Calculation Errors

Solver does not converge Check for circular flows without a stock process. The iterative solver needs at least one stock (or boundary) to break circular dependencies.

Mass balance error $> 10^{-3}$

- TCs not summing to 1.0 — check all outflow TCs per process
- Missing outflow for a process that receives inflow
- Element composition fractions exceeding 100%

Negative stock values DSM lifetime parameters may be misconfigured. If using Normal distribution, check that $\text{StdDev} < 0.8 \times \text{Mean}$. Consider switching to FoldedNormal or Weibull.

DSM element stock drops to zero If non-material element stocks (WC, DM, CC) drop to zero when inflow stops, update to the latest BioDYM version. This was a known bug fixed with cumulative composition tracking.

C.4 Visualization Issues

Plots not showing in Jupyter Ensure `plotly` is installed: `uv run pip install plotly`. Use JupyterLab (not classic Jupyter Notebook) for best compatibility.

Export produces blank image Install `kaleido` for static image export: `uv run pip install kaleido`.

Small text on exported PNGs Increase the `scale` parameter: `fig.write_image("plot.png", scale=3)` for 300 DPI.

C.5 Monte Carlo Issues

MC always returns same results Check that the `Distribution_Type` column is spelled correctly (lowercase: `normal`, `uniform`, `triangular`, `lognormal`).

High rejection rate If many samples are rejected during TC normalization, your uncertainty ranges may be too wide. Narrow the Min/Max bounds or reduce `StdDev`.

C.6 Getting Help

- Check the test suite: `uv run python -m pytest 04_tests/ -v`
- Report issues: https://github.com/JScholz-tech/Biodym_JS/issues